

CHAPTER 6

Mijbil the Otter

NCERT Exercise Solutions

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✨ Try each question yourself first, then check the answer. 💡 answers are samples: write your own.

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⭐ Let's Begin

1 **You have read the chapter 'Mijbil the Otter'. Discuss with your partner the commitment the author had towards Mijbil, what arrangements he made for his pet. What good care did he take like getting fish, taking it for a walk or exercise, providing things, and space to play etc. Make a list and then share with other friends in the class.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

The author's care for Mijbil:

- He fed Mij fish, which otters love, and let him eat in his own way.
- He gave him daily baths and let him play with water in the bath tub.
- He took him for walks on a leash in the streets of Basra.
- He gave him toys: rubber balls and marbles to juggle and play with.
- He let Mij sleep in his own bed.
- He made a special box for the plane journey, lined with metal.
- On the plane he looked after Mij himself and kept him calm.
- At Camusfearna he gave him freedom to swim in the sea and burn.

2 **Find out which illustrations will go with your list.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Match each point to the pictures in your textbook, e.g. Mij in the bath tub (baths), Mij on a leash (walks), Mij with a rubber ball (toys), Mij on the plane (journey box). (check the pictures in your book)

3 **Mijbil is an active animal who shows many emotions. Refer to the chapter and complete the following Table.**

What Mijbil Does → How Mijbil feels

1. Plunges, rolls in water → Goes wild with joy.

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

What Mijbil Does	How Mijbil feels
1. Plunges and rolls in water, splashing like a dolphin	Goes wild with joy
2. At first stays away from the author, does not respond	Aloof and indifferent
3. After a day, climbs into the author's bed and sleeps across his knees	Trusting and affectionate
4. Juggles marbles and plays with a rubber ball	Playful and happy
5. Is shut in the box, tears at its lining and cries	Frightened and desperate; in panic

6. On the plane, after escaping, comes back to the author's lap	Relieved and safe; loves his master

⭐ Reading Comprehension · Text I (Baby Bhakat)

Q.1 **Dharini — (a) is the land owner (b) loves animals (c) is a gardener (d) is father of Bhakat**

✔ ANSWER

(b) loves animals. The text says: "Dharini loves animals." He rescues and rehabilitates wild animals.

Q.2 **Civet cats are also called _____. (a) Baby cats (b) Night cats (c) Toddy cats (d) Snail cats**

✔ ANSWER

(c) Toddy cats. They live on palm trees and love to drink the sweet sap (toddy).

Q.3 **Baby Bhakat loves to eat _____. (a) roti (b) vegetables (c) fruits (d) meat**

✔ ANSWER

(d) meat. Bhakat says, "I like fruits. I love meat."

Q.4 **Baby Bhakat hates to _____. (a) eat snails (b) be in water (c) play with Mama (d) sleep in the rafter**

✔ ANSWER

(b) be in water. Bhakat says, “I hate to be in water!”

Q.5 **The home for the Bhakat is _____. (a) a garden near a river (b) the roof of the little hut (c) a little hut by a river (d) the nest in a coconut tree**

✔ ANSWER

(c) a little hut by a river. “My home is a little thatched hut by a river in a small village in Assam.”

Q.6 **Tick the statement which is not true. (a) Dharani and Anjali treat Bhakat as their own baby. (b) They keep the door closed to keep Bhakat safe. (c) Anjali plays with Bhakat and lets it be naughty. (d) Anjali feeds Bhakat before anyone else.**

✔ ANSWER

(b) is not true. The doors are “always open” and Bhakat comes and goes as it pleases.

Reading Comprehension · Text II (Human-wildlife conflict)

Q.1 What happens when communities expand?

✔ ANSWER

When communities expand, natural wild places are reduced. So people and wildlife increasingly come into conflict over living space and food.

Q.2 What is the meaning of "impact" in the passage? How it is affecting people and their life?

✔ ANSWER

"Impact" means the strong effect or harm caused by human-wildlife conflict.

People lose their crops and livestock (their income and food security), property and sometimes their lives. Even a severe injury by a wild animal can cause loss of livelihood.

Q.3 What will make the human-wildlife conflict more intense?

✔ ANSWER

The effects of climate change will probably make the human-wildlife conflict worse (more intense).

Q.4 **The passage talks about one solution to tackle human-wildlife conflict. What is it?**

✔ ANSWER

Planting a barrier of crops that repel the animals, e.g. chilli, which elephants and some other animals do not like. The chilli can also be sold to increase income.

Q.5 **These types of creative and simple solutions lead to — (Tick the statement(s) which is/are not true.) (a) active community involvement. (b) generate income naturally. (c) mutually beneficial coexistence. (d) people live with wildlife happily. (e) be more enthusiastic and supportive of conservation (f) developing sustainable livelihood.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

(b) and (d) are not true (not stated in the passage).

- (b): income comes from selling the chilli, not "naturally".
- (d): the passage says people "can live alongside wildlife", not that they live "happily".

(a), (c), (e) and (f) are stated in the passage.

Reading Comprehension · Text II (Animal rights)

Q.1 What do the people who support animal rights recognise?

✔ ANSWER

They recognise that all animals have an inherent worth, a value completely separate from their usefulness to humans, and every being with a will to live has the right to live free from exploitation and suffering.

Q.2 As human beings, what are our moral obligations towards animals?

✔ ANSWER

Animals feel pain, pleasure, fear, frustration, loneliness and familial love just as humans do. So whenever we think of doing something that would interfere with their needs, we are morally obligated to take them into account.

Q.3 What is the right of animals as mentioned in paragraph three?

✔ ANSWER

Animals have the right not to suffer at the hands of humans and to live their lives free from suffering and exploitation.

Q.4 **Why should we rediscover our empathy, compassion, and respect for animals?**

✔ ANSWER

All animals, pets or farm animals, are individuals with the same capacity to feel pain and fear. There is no logical or moral reason to treat them differently, so we should look past arbitrary distinctions and respect all animals equally.

Q.5 **Anyone who cares about animals can start putting "these principles" into practice. What are "these principles"?**

✔ ANSWER

"These principles" are the principles of animal rights: all animals have inherent worth, can feel pain and fear, and must be respected equally and kept free from suffering and exploitation. We practise them through the food we eat, the clothes we wear and the products we buy (cruelty-free choices).

⭐ Vocabulary

1(a) The following words are from the text you have read. The synonyms for each word are given. Find the odd one out. (a) serious, grave, ridiculous, stern, solemn

✔ ANSWER

ridiculous

1(b) suitable, unfitting, appropriate, right, proper

✔ ANSWER

unfitting

1(c) hostile, unfriendly, averse, agreeable, unreceptive

✔ ANSWER

agreeable

1(d) peaceful, harmonious, quiet, serene, violent

✔ ANSWER

violent

1(e) appalling, atrocious, wonderful, awful, dreadful

✔ ANSWER

wonderful

2 **Look at the two sentences given below. These are from the text. (a) By then it had crossed my mind... (b) Camusfearna, ringed by water... The noun forms of these two verbs are 'cross' and 'ring'.**

A list of words is given below. Make sentences using these words as verb and noun.

(c) Book (d) Mail (e) Cable (f) Sack (g) End (h) Head (i) Colour (j) Lead

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

(c) Book – Verb: I will book a ticket for Delhi. / Noun: She is reading a new book.

(d) Mail – Verb: Please mail me the report today. / Noun: I check my mail every morning.

(e) Cable – Verb: He cabled the news to his father. / Noun: The TV cable is broken.

(f) Sack – Verb: The manager sacked the lazy worker. / Noun: The farmer carried a sack of wheat.

(g) End – Verb: The meeting ended at five. / Noun: We waited till the end of the film.

(h) Head – Verb: Mrs Rao will head the committee. / Noun: He hurt his head in the fall.

(i) Colour – Verb: The children coloured the drawings. / Noun: My favourite colour is blue.

(j) Lead – Verb: The captain will lead the team. / Noun: The dog pulled at its lead. (also: a pencil's lead)

⭐ Grammar

1(a) **Join the sentences and make a simple sentence with an adjective phrase. I bought a Maruti car. The colour is blue. It is sporty. I bought _____ car.**

✔ ANSWER

I bought **a sporty blue Maruti** car.

1(b) **He made a speech. The speech was short. The speech was interesting. He made _____ speech.**

✔ ANSWER

He made **a short, interesting** speech.

1(c) **Suresh went to a house. It was decorated beautifully. Suresh went _____ house.**

✔ ANSWER

Suresh went **to a beautifully decorated** house.

1(d) She bought a dress. It is a designer one but frightfully expensive. She bought _____ dress.

✔ ANSWER

She bought **a frightfully expensive designer** dress.

1(e) The food was tasty. It was prepared quickly. _____ food was tasty.

✔ ANSWER

The quickly prepared food was tasty.

2(a) Use the correct form of the word given in the bracket. The death of 40 jawans was _____. We were _____ when we heard the news. (shock)

✔ ANSWER

shocking, **shocked**

2(b) I met an _____ person in the party. He was _____ in tasting each and every dish kept in the food counter. (interest)

✔ ANSWER

interesting, **interested**

2(c) Ravi is not very _____ to visit new places. He tells his friends no place is _____ compared to his village in Ranikhet. (excite)

✔ ANSWER

excited, **exciting**

2(d) She got a new guest in her house. She was _____ by his handling the pups. His voice was more _____ when he was calling these pups near him. (amuse)

✔ ANSWER

amused, **amusing**

2(e) It is very humid in the Summers. I don't like this weather. This weather is _____. I am _____ as I sweat a lot. Children are _____ as they can't play outside. (disgust)

✔ ANSWER

disgusting, **disgusted**, **disgusted**

3(a) Fill in the blanks with 'would' or 'used to'. Every day she _____ come home from work with a rose to give to her mother.

✔ ANSWER

would (repeated action)

3(b) **I _____ lend him my books when he was preparing for his examination.**

✔ ANSWER

would (repeated action; ‘used to’ is also acceptable)

3(c) **He _____ visit his friend in the hospital every evening.**

✔ ANSWER

would (repeated action every evening)

3(d) **Each time I called him he _____ come immediately.**

✔ ANSWER

would (repeated action each time)

3(e) **During his hostel life, he _____ eat all kinds of food without grumbling.**

✔ ANSWER

used to (a habit over a period of time in the past; ‘would’ is also possible)

3(f) **When I was a child, I _____ believe that fire flies were small fire balls.**

✔ ANSWER

used to (a past state/belief; ‘would’ is not used with verbs like ‘believe’)

⭐ Editing

1 **Use capital letters, full-stops, commas, and inverted commas wherever necessary in the following paragraph. “the land of the Bisnois in rajasthan is known for conservation of wildlife. it is a living religion to the Bishnois. It is said This is probably only one religion in the world that is founded on the principles of conserving nature. It has followers over ten lakhs. For these many people protection of living beings is a way of life for the ishnois tree is sacred and their empathy and love extend to all living beings on earth. They protect the ecosystem that surrounds the village which is a safe haven for blackbucks chinkaras vultures great Indian bustards peacocks etc they protect them from poachers and provide them plenty vegetation they keep water in the stone vessels for the animals to drink from, and hang water filled pots from the branches for the birds.”**

✔ ANSWER

The land of the Bishnois in Rajasthan is known for conservation of wildlife. It is a “living religion” to the Bishnois. It is said this is probably the only religion in the world that is founded on the principles of conserving nature. It has over ten lakh followers. For these many people, protection of living beings is a way of life. For the Bishnois, the tree is sacred, and their empathy and love extend to all living beings on earth. They protect the ecosystem that surrounds the village, which is a safe haven for blackbucks, chinkaras, vultures, great Indian bustards, peacocks, etc. They protect them from poachers and provide them plenty of vegetation. They keep water in stone vessels for the animals to drink from, and hang water-filled pots from the branches for the birds.

(Spelling slips in the book’s paragraph – “Bisnois”, “ishnois” – are written as “Bishnois”.)

2(a) **Rearrange the parts and write meaningful sentences. a town in iraq/ in large numbers/ otters are found/ in the marshes near Basra.**

✔ ANSWER

Otters are found in large numbers in the marshes near Basra, a town in Iraq.

2(b) **to the market/ we were fatigued/ having walked so far/ on account of**

✔ ANSWER

We were fatigued on account of having walked so far to the market.

2(c) **40 paramilitary personnel/ the suicide car/ pulwana district killed/ bombing in**

✔ ANSWER

The suicide car bombing in Pulwama district killed 40 paramilitary personnel.

2(d) **india's first semi-high speed train,/ was flagged off with excitement/ the inaugural trip of/ Vande Bharat Express,**

✔ ANSWER

The inaugural trip of Vande Bharat Express, India's first semi-high speed train, was flagged off with excitement.

2(e) **the eastern hemisphere/ the longer than all/ the nile is said to be/ other rivers in**

✔ ANSWER

The Nile is said to be longer than all other rivers in the eastern hemisphere.

⭐ Listening (Gangaram the crocodile)

1 **Why did the residents gather near the village pond?**

✔ ANSWER

They gathered near the community pond because they saw that their crocodile, Gangaram, had died.

2 **Why were the villagers crying?**

✔ ANSWER

They were emotionally attached to the crocodile and were heartbroken after his death.

3 **Who was Gangaram?**

✔ ANSWER

Gangaram was a 130-year-old crocodile of Bawamohatra village in Bemetra district, Chhattisgarh, whom the villagers loved and worshipped.

4 **How big was he?**

✔ ANSWER

He was over three metres long.

5 **How old was he?**

✔ ANSWER

A forest department official estimated that he was 130 years old.

6 **Give three reasons to justify Gangaram was friendly: (a) Children could _____. (b) Gangaram never _____. (c) Gangaram was very _____.**

✔ ANSWER

(a) Children could **swim around him**.

(b) Gangaram never **harmed or attacked anyone**.

(c) Gangaram was very **understanding; if he saw anyone swimming near him, he went to the other side of the pond**.

7 **What was the new name given to the village and why?**

✔ ANSWER

The village came to be called “Magarmachha vala gaaon” (the Crocodile’s village), because the villagers identified themselves with the crocodile Gangaram.

8 **What will the villagers do to remember their friend?**

✔ ANSWER

They wish to build a statue of Gangaram near the pond to remember him.

⭐ Speaking

1 **Try to make one hand puppet of an Otter. The situation is: Mijbil playing with water and spilling water every where. Write a few dialogues between Mijbil and Maxwell. Be the characters and exchange dialogues.**

Maxwell : Oh! Mijbil, what have you done?

Mijbil : He, he _____

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Maxwell: Oh! Mijbil, what have you done?

Mijbil: He, he! I just turned the tap and jumped into the bath. Water is my best friend!

Maxwell: But look at the floor! There is water everywhere, even on my bed.

Mijbil: Sorry, master! I was so happy, I rolled and splashed like a dolphin.

Maxwell: I know you love water, Mij. But next time play only in the tub.

Mijbil: I promise. Now, will you take me for a walk to the canal?

2 **Discuss in a group of four, the following points, list views, and then share in the class.**

(a) Keeping any big wild animal, like the sloth bears, at home.

(b) Keeping unusual pets for pleasure

(c) Using tigers, lions, dancing bears in circus

(d) Making the monkeys dance, cock fighting, bull fighting for amusement

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Points of view (model):

- (a) Big wild animals need space and their natural food; at home they become dangerous and unhappy. They belong in the wild or in sanctuaries.
- (b) Unusual pets are often taken from the wild illegally; they suffer in cages and many die. Pets should not be kept only for show.
- (c) Circus animals are trained by beating and starving; they lose their freedom. It is cruel and is restricted by law in India.
- (d) Dancing monkeys, cock fights and bull fights cause pain and injury for human fun. Such cruelty must stop; animals have a right to live free from suffering.

⭐ Writing

1 **Based on the above points, write a paragraph giving your points of view. You can highlight**

on the loss of natural habitat, cruelty, loss of freedom etc.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Wild Animals Belong to the Wild

Wild animals are not toys for our pleasure. When we keep a big animal like a sloth bear at home, or an unusual pet in a cage, we take it away from its natural habitat, its food and its family. Such animals lose their freedom and often fall ill or become dangerous. In circuses, tigers, lions and bears are trained through fear, hunger and beating. Dancing monkeys, cock fights and bull fights give pain to animals only for human fun. This is plain cruelty. Forests are already shrinking, and animals are losing their homes. We should protect them in sanctuaries and national parks, report cruelty, and teach others that every animal has a right to live freely.

2 **Read these quotations and write one paragraph in the context of 'Animal Rights'.**

(a) "The greatness of a nation and its moral progress can be judged by the way its animals are treated." – Mahatma Gandhi

(b) "When it comes to pain, love, joy, loneliness and fear, a rat is a pig is a dog is a boy. Each one values his or her life and fights the knife." – PETA founder, Ingrid E. Newkirk

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Animal Rights

Mahatma Gandhi said that the greatness of a nation can be judged by the way its animals are treated. Ingrid Newkirk reminds us that a rat, a pig, a dog and a boy all feel pain, love, joy, loneliness and fear in the same way. Both quotations tell us that animals are living beings with feelings, not objects for our use. Every animal values its life and tries to save it. So we have a moral duty not to harm them for food, fashion or fun. A truly civilised nation protects stray animals, stops cruelty in farms and circuses, and saves forests for wildlife. Small steps, like feeding strays, choosing cruelty-free products and reporting abuse, show real moral progress.

🛠️ Project

1 **In a group of four, conduct research on the following question and write a report on the findings.**

What animals can be exported or imported under law?

(Customs seizures show a variety of animals from reptiles, lizards, leopards to pythons, venomous reptile. These are carried in tiny suitcases and smuggled.)

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Report: Trade in Animals and the Law (points to research and verify)

- In India, the **Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972** bans hunting and trade of wild animals listed in its Schedules (e.g. tigers, leopards, pythons, star tortoises, many birds).
- Import and export of animals is controlled by the **Foreign Trade Policy** (DGFT) and **CITES**, an international agreement; species in CITES Appendix I cannot be traded for commercial purposes.
- Domestic animals and pets (dogs, cats), livestock and some exotic species can be imported only with permits, health certificates and quarantine checks.
- Customs often seize smuggled turtles, lizards, snakes, birds and big-cat skins at airports; smuggling is punished with jail and fine.
- Conclusion: buying exotic or wild pets encourages smuggling and cruelty; we should not buy them and should report illegal trade.

2 **Make a team of four students. Imagine a unique animal or bird as a pet. Draw the animal and write the following information about it.**

(a) Name of the pet and draw the animal on a chart paper.

(b) My pet: (Make a table like the following and write its specifications) has / can / is

(c) What all do you have to do to keep the animal with you at home? (You can refer to the dos and don'ts given on page no. 102 of the textbook First Flight.)

(d) Prepare a write up, share it in the class, and put it on the wall for the class to read.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

(a) Name: Chirpy, a rainbow-feathered talking bird (draw it on chart paper).

(b) My pet:

has	can	is
soft colourful feathers, a curved beak, sharp eyes, long tail	fly, sing, copy words, show affection	small, smart, gentle, a good singer

(c) To keep it at home:

- Give it a large clean space and let it fly safely every day.
- Give fresh water, fruits and seeds on time.
- Keep it away from heat, smoke and other pets that may harm it.
- Take it to a vet for check-ups; never tie it or keep it hungry.

(d) Write-up: Chirpy is our imaginary pet bird. She has bright feathers, sings sweetly and copies a few words. She is gentle and loves company. We give her a big airy space, fresh food and water, and plenty of love. Caring for a pet teaches us kindness and responsibility.

🎉 **Chapter 6 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**